[39] His father Isaac answered him: "Behold, your dwelling place shall be away from
the richness of the land, away from the dew of heaven above." [40] "You shall live
by the sword and serve your brother. But when you rebel, you will tear his yoke
from your neck." [41] Esau held a grudge against Jacob because of the blessing his
father had given him. And Esau said in his heart, "The days of mourning for my
father are at hand; then I will kill my brother Jacob." [42] When the words of her
older son Esau were relayed to Rebekah, she sent for her younger son Jacob and
told him, "Look, your brother Esau is consoling himself by plotting to kill you."
[43] So now, my son, obey my voice and flee at once to my brother Laban in Haran.
[44] Stay with him for a while, until your brother's fury subsides— [45] "until your
brother's rage against you wanes and he forgets what you have done to him. Then
I will send for you and bring you back from there. Why should I lose both of you
in one day?" [46] Then Rebekah said to Isaac, "I am weary of my life because of
these Hittite women. If Jacob takes a Hittite wife from among them, what good
is my life?"

28 So Isaac called for Jacob and blessed him. "Do not take a wife from the
Canaanite women," he commanded. [2] "Go at once to Paddan-aram, to the house
of your mother's father Bethuel, and take a wife from among the daughters of
Laban, your mother's brother." [3] May God Almighty bless you and make you
fruitful and multiply you, so that you may become a company of peoples.
[4] "And may He give the blessing of Abraham to you and your descendants, so
that you may possess the land where you dwell as a foreigner, the land God gave
to Abraham." [5] So Isaac sent Jacob to Paddan-aram, to Laban son of Bethuel
the Aramean, the brother of Rebekah, who was the mother of Jacob and Esau.
[6] Now Esau learned that Isaac had blessed Jacob and sent him to Paddan-aram
to take a wife there, commanding him, "Do not marry a Canaanite woman,"
[7] and that Jacob had obeyed his father and mother and gone to Paddan-aram.
[8] And seeing that his father Isaac disapproved of the Canaanite women, [9] Esau
went to Ishmael and married Mahalath, the sister of Nebaioth and daughter of
Abraham's son Ishmael, in addition to the wives he already had.

[10] Meanwhile Jacob left Beersheba and set out for Haran. [11] On reaching a certain
place, he spent the night there because the sun had set. And taking one of the
stones from that place, he put it under his head and lay down to sleep. [12] And
Jacob had a dream about a ladder that rested on the earth with its top reaching
up to heaven, and God's angels were going up and down the ladder. [13] And there
at the top the LORD was standing and saying, "I am the LORD, the God of
your father Abraham and the God of Isaac. I will give you and your descendants
the land on which you now lie."

[14] Your descendants will be like the dust of the earth, and you will spread out to
the west and east and north and south. All the families of the earth will be blessed
through you and your offspring. [15] "Look, I am with you, and I will watch over
you wherever you go, and I will bring you back to this land. For I will not leave
you until I have done what I have promised you." [16] When Jacob woke up, he
thought, "Surely the LORD is in this place, and I was unaware of it." [17] And
he was afraid and said, "How awesome is this place! This is none other than the
house of God; this is the gate of heaven!" [18] Early the next morning, Jacob took
the stone that he had placed under his head, and he set it up as a pillar. He poured
oil on top of it, [19] and he called that place Bethel, though previously the city had
been named Luz. [20] Then Jacob made a vow, saying, "If God will be with me
and watch over me on this journey, and if He will provide me with food to eat
and clothes to wear," [21] so that I may return safely to my father's house, then the
LORD will be my God. [22] "And this stone I have set up as a pillar will be God's
house, and of all that You give me I will surely give You a tenth."

29 Jacob resumed his journey and came to the land of the people of the east.
[2] He looked and saw a well in the field, and near it lay three flocks of sheep,
because the sheep were watered from this well. And a large stone covered the
mouth of the well. [3] When all the flocks had been gathered there, the shepherds
would roll away the stone from the mouth of the well and water the sheep.
Then they would return the stone to its place over the mouth of the well. [4] "My
brothers," Jacob asked the shepherds, "where are you from?" "We are from
Haran," they answered. [5] "Do you know Laban the grandson of Nahor?" Jacob
asked. "We know him," they replied. [6] "Is he well?" Jacob inquired. "Yes," they
answered, "and here comes his daughter Rachel with his sheep." [7] "Look," said
Jacob, "it is still broad daylight; it is not yet time to gather the livestock. Water the
sheep and take them back to pasture." [8] But they replied, "We cannot, until all
the flocks have been gathered and the stone has been rolled away from the mouth
of the well. Then we will water the sheep." [9] While he was still speaking with
them, Rachel arrived with her father's sheep, for she was a shepherdess. [10] As soon
as Jacob saw Rachel, the daughter of his mother's brother Laban, with Laban's
sheep, he went up and rolled the stone away from the mouth of the well and
watered his uncle's sheep.

[11] Then Jacob kissed Rachel and wept aloud. [12] He told Rachel that he was
Rebekah's son, a relative of her father, and she ran and told her father. [13] When
Laban heard the news about his sister's son Jacob, he ran out to meet him. He
embraced him and kissed him and brought him to his home, where Jacob told
him all that had happened. [14] Then Laban declared, "You are indeed my own
flesh and blood." After Jacob had stayed with him a month, [15] Laban said to him,
"Just because you are my relative, should you work for nothing? Tell me what
your wages should be." [16] Now Laban had two daughters; the older was named
Leah, and the younger was named Rachel. [17] Leah had weak eyes, but Rachel was
shapely and beautiful. [18] Since Jacob loved Rachel, he answered, "I will serve you
seven years for your younger daughter Rachel." [19] Laban replied, "Better that I
give her to you than to another. Stay here with me." [20] So Jacob served seven years
for Rachel, yet it seemed but a few days because of his love for her. [21] Finally Jacob
said to Laban, "Grant me my wife, for my time is complete, and I want to sleep
with her." [22] So Laban invited all the men of that place and prepared a feast.

[23] But when evening came, Laban took his daughter Leah and gave her to Jacob,
and he slept with her. [24] And Laban gave his servant girl Zilpah to his daughter
Leah as her maidservant. [25] When morning came, there was Leah! "What have
you done to me?" Jacob said to Laban. "Wasn't it for Rachel that I served you?
Why have you deceived me?" [26] Laban replied, "It is not our custom here to
give the younger daughter in marriage before the older." [27] "Finish this week's
celebration, and we will give you the younger one in return for another seven
years of work." [28] And Jacob did just that. He finished the week's celebration,
and Laban gave him his daughter Rachel as his wife. [29] Laban also gave his servant
girl Bilhah to his daughter Rachel as her maidservant. [30] Jacob slept with Rachel
as well, and indeed, he loved Rachel more than Leah. So he worked for Laban
another seven years. [31] When the LORD saw that Leah was unloved, He opened
her womb; but Rachel was barren. [32] And Leah conceived and gave birth to a son,
and she named him Reuben, for she said, "The LORD has seen my affliction.
Surely my husband will love me now." [33] Again she conceived and gave birth to a
son, and she said, "Because the LORD has heard that I am unloved, He has given
me this son as well." So she named him Simeon. [34] Once again Leah conceived and
gave birth to a son, and she said, "Now at last my husband will become attached
to me, because I have borne him three sons." So he was named Levi. [35] And once
more she conceived and gave birth to a son and said, "This time I will praise the
LORD." So she named him Judah. Then Leah stopped having children.

30 When Rachel saw that she was not bearing any children for Jacob, she
envied her sister. "Give me children, or I will die!" she said to Jacob. [2] Jacob
became angry with Rachel and said, "Am I in the place of God, who has
withheld children from you?" [3] Then she said, "Here is my maidservant Bilhah.
Sleep with her, that she may bear children for me, so that through her I too
can build a family." [4] So Rachel gave Jacob her servant Bilhah as a wife, and he
slept with her, [5] and Bilhah conceived and bore him a son. [6] Then Rachel said,
"God has vindicated me; He has heard my plea and given me a son." So she
named him Dan. [7] And Rachel's servant Bilhah conceived again and bore Jacob
a second son. [8] Then Rachel said, "In my great struggles, I have wrestled with
my sister and won." So she named him Naphtali. [9] When Leah saw that she had
stopped having children, she gave her servant Zilpah to Jacob as a wife. [10] And
Leah's servant Zilpah bore Jacob a son. [11] Then Leah said, "How fortunate!" So
she named him Gad. [12] When Leah's servant Zilpah bore Jacob a second son,
[13] Leah said, "How happy I am! For the women call me happy." So she named
him Asher.

[14] Now during the wheat harvest, Reuben went out and found some
mandrakes in the field. When he brought them to his mother, Rachel begged
Leah, "Please give me some of your son's mandrakes." [15] But Leah replied, "Is
it not enough that you have taken away my husband? Now you want to take
my son's mandrakes as well?" "Very well," said Rachel, "he may sleep with you
tonight in exchange for your son's mandrakes." [16] When Jacob came in from the
field that evening, Leah went out to meet him and said, "You must come with me,
for I have hired you with my son's mandrakes." So he slept with her that night.
[17] And God listened to Leah, and she conceived and bore a fifth son to Jacob.

[18] Then Leah said, "God has rewarded me for giving my maidservant to my
husband." So she named him Issachar. [19] Again Leah conceived and bore a sixth
son to Jacob. [20] "God has given me a good gift," she said. "This time my husband
will honor me, because I have borne him six sons." And she named him Zebulun.
[21] After that, Leah gave birth to a daughter and named her Dinah. [22] Then
God remembered Rachel. He listened to her and opened her womb, [23] and she
conceived and gave birth to a son. "God has taken away my shame," she said.
[24] She named him Joseph, and said, "May the LORD add to me another son."
[25] Now after Rachel had given birth to Joseph, Jacob said to Laban, "Send me on
my way so I can return to my homeland." [26] "Give me my wives and children for
whom I have served you, that I may go on my way. You know how hard I have
worked for you." [27] But Laban replied, "If I have found favor in your eyes, please
stay. I have learned by divination that the LORD has blessed me because of you."

[28] And he added, "Name your wages, and I will pay them." [29] Then Jacob
answered, "You know how I have served you and how your livestock have thrived
under my care." [30] "Indeed, you had very little before my arrival, but now your
wealth has increased many times over. The LORD has blessed you wherever I
set foot. But now, when may I also provide for my own household?" [31] "What
can I give you?" Laban asked. "You do not need to give me anything," Jacob
replied. "If you do this one thing for me, I will keep on shepherding and
keeping your flocks." [32] Let me go through all your flocks today and remove
from them every speckled or spotted sheep, every dark-colored lamb, and every
spotted or speckled goat. These will be my wages. [33] "So my honesty will testify
for me when you come to check on my wages in the future. If I have any goats
that are not speckled or spotted, or any lambs that are not dark-colored, they
will be considered stolen." [34] "Agreed," said Laban. "Let it be as you have said."

[35] That very day Laban removed all the streaked or spotted male goats and every speckled or spotted female goat—every one that had any white on it—and every dark-colored lamb, and he placed them under the care of his sons. [36] Then he put a three-day journey between himself and Jacob, while Jacob was shepherding the rest of Laban's flocks. [37] Jacob, however, took fresh branches of poplar, almond, and plane trees, and peeled the bark, exposing the white inner wood of the branches. [38] Then he set the peeled branches in the watering troughs in front of the flocks coming in to drink. So when the flocks were in heat and came to drink, [39] they mated in front of the branches. And they bore young that were streaked or speckled or spotted. [40] Jacob set apart the young, but made the rest face the streaked dark-colored sheep in Laban's flocks. Then he set his own stock apart and did not put them with Laban's animals. [41] Whenever the stronger females of the flock were in heat, Jacob would place the branches in the troughs, in full view of the animals, so that they would breed in front of the branches. [42] But if the animals were weak, he did not set out the branches. So the weaker animals went to Laban and the stronger ones to Jacob. [43] Thus Jacob became exceedingly prosperous. He owned large flocks, maidservants and menservants, and camels and donkeys.

31 Now Jacob heard that Laban's sons were saying, "Jacob has taken away all that belonged to our father and built all this wealth at our father's expense." [2] And Jacob saw from the countenance of Laban that his attitude toward him had changed. [3] Then the LORD said to Jacob, "Go back to the land of your fathers and to your kindred, and I will be with you." [4] So Jacob sent word and called Rachel and Leah to the field where his flocks were, [5] and he told them, "I can see from your father's countenance that his attitude toward me has changed; but the God of my father has been with me." [6] You know that I have served your father with all my strength. [7] And although he has cheated me and changed my wages ten times, God has not allowed him to harm me. [8] If he said, 'The speckled will be your wages,' then the whole flock bore speckled offspring. If he said, 'The streaked will be your wages,' then the whole flock bore streaked offspring. [9] Thus God has taken away your father's livestock and given them to me. [10] When the flocks were breeding, I saw in a dream that the streaked, spotted, and speckled males were mating with the females. [11] In that dream the angel of God said to me, 'Jacob!' And I replied, 'Here I am.' [12] 'Look up,' he said, 'and see that all the males that are mating with the flock are streaked, spotted, or speckled; for I have seen all that Laban has done to you.' [13] "I am the God of Bethel, where you anointed the pillar and made a solemn vow to Me. Now get up and leave this land at once, and return to your native land.'" [14] And Rachel and Leah replied, "Do we have any portion or inheritance left in our father's house?" [15] Are we not regarded by him as outsiders? Not only has he sold us, but he has certainly squandered what was paid for us. [16] "Surely all the wealth that God has taken away from our father belongs to us and to our children. So do whatever God has told you." [17] Then Jacob got up and put his children and his wives on camels, [18] and he drove all his livestock before him, along with all the possessions he had acquired in Paddan-aram, to go to his father Isaac in the land in Canaan. [19] Now while Laban was out shearing his sheep, Rachel stole her father's household idols. [20] Moreover, Jacob deceived Laban the Aramean by not telling him that he was running away. [21] So he fled with all his possessions, crossed the Euphrates, and headed for the hill country of Gilead. [22] On the third day Laban was informed that Jacob had fled.

[23] So he took his relatives with him, pursued Jacob for seven days, and overtook him in the hill country of Gilead. [24] But that night God came to Laban the Aramean in a dream and warned him, "Be careful not to say anything to Jacob, either good or bad." [25] Now Jacob had pitched his tent in the hill country of Gilead when Laban overtook him, and Laban and his relatives camped there as well. [26] Then Laban said to Jacob, "What have you done? You have deceived me and carried off my daughters like captives of war!" [27] Why did you run away secretly and deceive me, without even telling me? I would have sent you away with joy and singing, with tambourines and harps. [28] But you did not even let me kiss my grandchildren and my daughters goodbye. Now you have done a foolish thing. [29] I have power to do you great harm, but last night the God of your father said to me, 'Be careful not to say anything to Jacob, either good or bad.' [30] "Now you have gone off because you long for your father's house. But why have you stolen my gods?" [31] "I was afraid," Jacob answered, "for I thought you would take your daughters from me by force." [32] "If you find your gods with anyone here, he shall not live! In the presence of our relatives, see for yourself if anything is yours, and take it back." For Jacob did not know that Rachel had stolen the idols. [33] So Laban went into Jacob's tent, then Leah's tent, and then the tents of the two maidservants, but he found nothing. Then he left Leah's tent and entered Rachel's tent. [34] Now Rachel had taken Laban's household idols, put them in the saddlebag of her camel, and was sitting on them. And Laban searched everything in the tent but found nothing. [35] Rachel said to her father, "Sir, do not be angry that I cannot stand up before you; for I am having my period." So Laban searched, but could not find the household idols.

[36] Then Jacob became incensed and challenged Laban. "What is my crime?" he said. "For what sin of mine have you so hotly pursued me?" [37] You have searched all my goods! Have you found anything that belongs to you? Put it here before my brothers and yours, that they may judge between the two of us. [38] I have been with you for twenty years now. Your sheep and goats have not miscarried, nor have I eaten the rams of your flock. [39] I did not bring you anything torn by wild beasts; I bore the loss myself. And you demanded payment from me for what was stolen by day or night. [40] As it was, the heat consumed me by day and the frost by night, and sleep fled from my eyes. [41] Thus for twenty years I have served in your household—fourteen years for your two daughters and six years for your flocks —and you have changed my wages ten times! [42] "If the God of my father, the God of Abraham and the Fear of Isaac, had not been with me, surely by now you would have sent me away empty-handed. But God has seen my affliction and the toil of my hands, and last night He rendered judgment." [43] But Laban answered Jacob, "These daughters are my daughters, these sons are my sons, and these flocks are my flocks! Everything you see is mine! Yet what can I do today about these daughters of mine or the children they have borne?" [44] "Come now, let us make a covenant, you and I, and let it serve as a witness between you and me." [45] So Jacob picked out a stone and set it up as a pillar, [46] and he said to his relatives, "Gather some stones." So they took stones and made a mound, and there by the mound they ate. [47] Laban called it Jegar-sahadutha, and Jacob called it Galeed. [48] Then Laban declared, "This mound is a witness between you and me this day." Therefore the place was called Galeed. [49] It was also called Mizpah, because Laban said, "May the LORD keep watch between you and me when we are absent from each other." [50] "If you mistreat my daughters or take other wives, although no one is with us, remember that God is a witness between you and me." [51] Laban also said to Jacob, "Here is the mound, and here is the pillar I have set up between you and me." [52] This mound is a witness, and this pillar is a witness, that I will not go past this mound to harm you, and you will not go past this mound and pillar to harm me. [53] "May the God of Abraham and the God of Nahor, the God of their father, judge between us." So Jacob swore by the Fear of his father Isaac. [54] Then Jacob offered a sacrifice on the mountain and invited his relatives to eat a meal. And after they had eaten, they spent the night on the mountain. [55] Early the next morning, Laban got up and kissed his grandchildren and daughters and blessed them. Then he left to return home.

32 Jacob also went on his way, and the angels of God met him. [2] When Jacob saw them, he said, "This is the camp of God." So he named that place Mahanaim. [3] Jacob sent messengers ahead of him to his brother Esau in the land of Seir, the country of Edom. [4] He instructed them, "You are to say to my master Esau, 'Your servant Jacob says: I have been staying with Laban and have remained there until now.'" [5] "I have oxen, donkeys, flocks, menservants, and maidservants. I have sent this message to inform my master, so that I may find favor in your sight.'" [6] When the messengers returned to Jacob, they said, "We went to your brother Esau, and now he is coming to meet you—he and four hundred men with him." [7] In great fear and distress, Jacob divided his people into two camps, as well as the flocks and herds and camels. [8] He thought, "If Esau comes and attacks one camp, then the other camp can escape." [9] Then Jacob declared, "O God of my father Abraham, God of my father Isaac, the LORD who told me, 'Go back to your country and to your kindred, and I will make you prosper,'" [10] I am unworthy of all the kindness and faithfulness You have shown Your servant. Indeed, with only my staff I came across the Jordan, but now I have become two camps. [11] Please deliver me from the hand of my brother Esau, for I am afraid that he may come and attack me and the mothers and children with me. [12] "But You have said, 'I will surely make you prosper, and I will make your offspring like the sand of the sea, too numerous to count.'" [13] Jacob spent the night there, and from what he had brought with him, he selected a gift for his brother Esau: [14] 200 female goats, 20 male goats, 200 ewes, 20 rams, [15] 30 milk camels with their young, 40 cows, 10 bulls, 20 female donkeys, and 10 male donkeys. [16] He entrusted them to his servants in separate herds and told them, "Go on ahead of me, and keep some distance between the herds." [17] He instructed the one in the lead, "When my brother Esau meets you and asks, 'To whom do you belong, where are you going, and whose animals are these before you?'"

[18] "then you are to say, 'They belong to your servant Jacob. They are a gift, sent to my lord Esau. And behold, Jacob is behind us.'" [19] He also instructed the second, the third, and all those following behind the herds: "When you meet Esau, you are to say the same thing to him." [20] "You are also to say, 'Look, your servant Jacob is right behind us.'" For he thought, "I will appease Esau with the gift that is going before me. After that I can face him, and perhaps he will accept me."

[21] So Jacob's gifts went on before him, while he spent the night in the camp. [22] During the night Jacob got up and took his two wives, his two maidservants, and his eleven sons, and crossed the ford of the Jabbok. [23] He took them and sent them across the stream, along with all his possessions. [24] So Jacob was left all alone, and there a man wrestled with him until daybreak. [25] When the man saw that he could not overpower Jacob, he struck the socket of Jacob's hip and dislocated it as they wrestled. [26] Then the man said, "Let me go, for it is daybreak." But Jacob replied, "I will not let you go unless you bless me." [27] "What is your name?" the man asked. "Jacob," he replied. [28] Then the man said, "Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with men, and you have prevailed." [29] And Jacob requested, "Please tell me your name." But he replied, "Why do you ask my name?" Then he blessed Jacob there. [30] So Jacob named the place Peniel, saying, "Indeed, I have seen God face to face, and yet my life was spared." [31] The sun rose above him as he passed by Penuel, and he was limping because of his hip. [32] Therefore to this day the Israelites do not eat the tendon which is at the socket of the hip, because the socket of Jacob's hip was struck near that tendon.

33 Now Jacob looked up and saw Esau coming toward him with four hundred men. So he divided the children among Leah, Rachel, and the

two maidservants. [2] He put the maidservants and their children in front, Leah and her children next, and Rachel and Joseph at the rear. [3] But Jacob himself went on ahead and bowed to the ground seven times as he approached his brother. [4] Esau, however, ran to him and embraced him, threw his arms around his neck, and kissed him. And they both wept. [5] When Esau looked up and saw the women and children, he asked, "Who are these with you?" Jacob answered, "These are the children God has graciously given your servant." [6] Then the maidservants and their children approached and bowed down. [7] Leah and her children also approached and bowed down, and then Joseph and Rachel approached and bowed down. [8] "What do you mean by sending this whole company to meet me?" asked Esau. "To find favor in your sight, my lord," Jacob answered.

[9] "I already have plenty, my brother," Esau replied. "Keep what belongs to you." [10] But Jacob insisted, "No, please! If I have found favor in your sight, then receive this gift from my hand. For indeed, I have seen your face, and it is like seeing the face of God, since you have received me favorably." [11] "Please accept my gift that was brought to you, because God has been gracious to me and I have all I need." So Jacob pressed him until he accepted. [12] Then Esau said, "Let us be on our way, and I will go ahead of you." [13] But Jacob replied, "My lord knows that the children are frail, and I must care for sheep and cattle that are nursing their young. If they are driven hard for even a day, all the animals will die." [14] "Please let my lord go ahead of his servant. I will continue on slowly, at a comfortable pace for the livestock and children, until I come to my lord at Seir." [15] "Let me leave some of my people with you," Esau said. But Jacob replied, "Why do that? Let me find favor in the sight of my lord." [16] So that day Esau started on his way back to Seir, [17] but Jacob went on to Succoth, where he built a house for himself and shelters for his livestock; that is why the place was called Succoth. [18] After Jacob had come from Paddan-aram, he arrived safely at the city of Shechem in the land of Canaan, and he camped just outside the city. [19] And the plot of ground where he pitched his tent, he purchased from the sons of Hamor, Shechem's father, for a hundred pieces of silver. [20] There he set up an altar and called it El-Elohe-Israel.

34 Now Dinah, the daughter Leah had borne to Jacob, went out to visit the daughters of the land. [2] When Shechem son of Hamor the Hivite, the prince of the region, saw her, he took her and lay with her by force. [3] And his soul was drawn to Dinah, the daughter of Jacob. He loved the young girl and spoke to her tenderly. [4] So Shechem told his father Hamor, "Get me this girl as a wife." [5] Jacob heard that Shechem had defiled his daughter Dinah, but since his sons were with his livestock in the field, he remained silent about it until they returned. [6] Meanwhile, Shechem's father Hamor came to speak with Jacob. [7] When Jacob's sons heard what had happened, they returned from the field. They were filled with grief and fury, because Shechem had committed an outrage in Israel by lying with Jacob's daughter—a thing that should not be done. [8] But Hamor said to them, "My son Shechem longs for your daughter. Please give her to him as his wife." [9] Intermarry with us; give us your daughters, and take our daughters for yourselves.

[10] "You may settle among us, and the land will be open to you. Live here, move about freely, and acquire your own property." [11] Then Shechem said to Dinah's father and brothers, "Grant me this favor, and I will give you whatever you ask." [12] "Demand a high dowry and an expensive gift, and I will give you whatever you ask. Only give me the girl as my wife!" [13] But because Shechem had defiled their sister Dinah, Jacob's sons answered him and his father Hamor deceitfully. [14] "We cannot do such a thing," they said. "To give our sister to an uncircumcised man would be a disgrace to us." [15] We will consent to this on one condition, that you become circumcised like us—every one of your males. [16] Then we will give you our daughters and take your daughters for ourselves. We will dwell among you and become one people. [17] "But if you will not agree to be circumcised, then we will take our sister and go." [18] Their offer seemed good to Hamor and his son Shechem. [19] The young man, who was the most respected of all his father's household, did not hesitate to fulfill this request, because he was delighted with Jacob's daughter.

[20] So Hamor and his son Shechem went to the gate of their city and addressed the men of their city: [21] "These men are at peace with us. Let them live and trade in our land; indeed, it is large enough for them. Let us take their daughters in marriage and give our daughters to them." [22] But only on this condition will the men agree to dwell with us and be one people: if all our men are circumcised as they are. [23] "Will not their livestock, their possessions, and all their animals become ours? Only let us consent to them, and they will dwell among us." [24] All the men who went out of the city gate listened to Hamor and his son Shechem, and every male of the city was circumcised. [25] Three days later, while they were still in pain, two of Jacob's sons (Dinah's brothers Simeon and Levi) took their swords, went into the unsuspecting city, and slaughtered every male. [26] They killed Hamor and his son Shechem with their swords, took Dinah out of Shechem's house, and went away. [27] Jacob's other sons came upon the slaughter and looted the city, because their sister had been defiled. [28] They took their flocks and herds and donkeys, and everything else in the city or in the field. [29] They carried off all their possessions and women and children, and they plundered everything in their houses. [30] Then Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, "You have brought trouble upon me by making me a stench to the Canaanites and Perizzites, the people of this land. We are few in number; if they unite against me and attack me, I and my household will be destroyed." [31] But they replied, "Should he have treated our sister like a prostitute?"

35 Then God said to Jacob, "Arise, go up to Bethel, and settle there. Build an altar there to the God who appeared to you when you fled from your brother Esau." [2] So Jacob told his household and all who were with him, "Get rid of the foreign gods that are among you. Purify yourselves and change your garments." [3] "Then let us arise and go to Bethel. I will build an altar there to God, who answered me in my day of distress. He has been with me wherever I have gone." [4] So they gave Jacob all their foreign gods and all their earrings, and Jacob buried them under the oak near Shechem. [5] As they set out, a terror from God fell over the surrounding cities, so that they did not pursue Jacob's sons. [6] So Jacob and everyone with him arrived in Luz (that is, Bethel) in the land of Canaan. [7] There Jacob built an altar, and he called that place El-bethel, because it was there that God had revealed Himself to Jacob as he fled from his brother. [8] Now Deborah, Rebekah's nurse, died and was buried under the oak below Bethel. So Jacob named it Allon-bachuth.

[9] After Jacob had returned from Paddan-aram, God appeared to him again and blessed him. [10] And God said to him, "Though your name is Jacob, you will no longer be called Jacob. Instead, your name will be Israel." So God named him Israel. [11] And God told him, "I am God Almighty. Be fruitful and multiply. A nation—even a company of nations—shall come from you, and kings shall descend from you." [12] "The land that I gave to Abraham and Isaac I will give to you, and I will give this land to your descendants after you." [13] Then God went up from the place where He had spoken with him. [14] So Jacob set up a pillar in the place where God had spoken with him—a stone marker—and he poured out a drink offering on it and anointed it with oil. [15] Jacob called the place where God had spoken with him Bethel. [16] Later, they set out from Bethel, and while they were still some distance from Ephrath, Rachel began to give birth, and her labor was difficult. [17] During her severe labor, the midwife said to her, "Do not be afraid, for you are having another son." [18] And with her last breath—for she was dying—she named him Ben-oni. But his father called him Benjamin.

[19] So Rachel died and was buried on the way to Ephrath (that is, Bethlehem). [20] Jacob set up a pillar on her grave; it marks Rachel's tomb to this day. [21] Israel again set out and pitched his tent beyond the Tower of Eder. [22] While Israel was living in that region, Reuben went in and slept with his father's concubine Bilhah, and Israel heard about it. Jacob had twelve sons: [23] The sons of Leah were Reuben the firstborn of Jacob, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, and Zebulun. [24] The sons of Rachel were Joseph and Benjamin. [25] The sons of Rachel's maidservant Bilhah were Dan and Naphtali. [26] And the sons of Leah's maidservant Zilpah were Gad and Asher. These are the sons of Jacob, who were born to him in Paddan-aram. [27] Jacob returned to his father Isaac at Mamre, near Kiriath-arba (that is, Hebron), where Abraham and Isaac had stayed. [28] And Isaac lived 180 years. [29] Then he breathed his last and died and was gathered to his people, old and full of years. And his sons Esau and Jacob buried him.

36 This is the account of Esau (that is, Edom). [2] Esau took his wives from the daughters of Canaan: Adah daughter of Elon the Hittite, Oholibamah daughter of Anah and granddaughter of Zibeon the Hivite, [3] and Basemath daughter of Ishmael and sister of Nebaioth. [4] And Adah bore Eliphaz to Esau, Basemath gave birth to Reuel, [5] and Oholibamah gave birth to Jeush, Jalam, and Korah. These were the sons of Esau, who were born to him in the land of Canaan. [6] Later, Esau took his wives and sons and daughters and all the people of his household, along with his livestock, all his other animals, and all the property he had acquired in Canaan, and he moved to a land far away from his brother Jacob. [7] For their possessions were too great for them to dwell together; the land where they stayed could not support them because of their livestock. [8] So Esau (that is, Edom) settled in the area of Mount Seir.

[9] This is the account of Esau, the father of the Edomites, in the area of Mount Seir.

[10] These are the names of Esau's sons: Eliphaz son of Esau's wife Adah, and Reuel son of Esau's wife Basemath.

[11] The sons of Eliphaz were Teman, Omar, Zepho, Gatam, and Kenaz.

[12] Additionally, Timna, a concubine of Esau's son Eliphaz, gave birth to Amalek. These are the grandsons of Esau's wife Adah.

[13] These are the sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. They are the grandsons of Esau's wife Basemath.

[14] These are the sons of Esau's wife Oholibamah (daughter of Anah and granddaughter of Zibeon) whom she bore to Esau: Jeush, Jalam, and Korah.

[15] These are the chiefs among the sons of Esau. The sons of Eliphaz the firstborn of Esau: Chiefs Teman, Omar, Zepho, Kenaz,

[16] Korah, Gatam, and Amalek. They are the chiefs of Eliphaz in the land of Edom, and they are the grandsons of Adah.

[17] These are the sons of Esau's son Reuel: Chiefs Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. They are the chiefs descended from Reuel in the land of Edom, and they are the grandsons of Esau's wife Basemath.

[18] These are the sons of Esau's wife Oholibamah: Chiefs Jeush, Jalam, and Korah. They are the chiefs descended from Esau's wife Oholibamah, the daughter of Anah.

[19] All these are the sons of Esau (that is, Edom), and they were their chiefs.

[20] These are the sons of Seir the Horite, who were living in the land: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah,

[21] Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. They are the chiefs of the Horites, the descendants of Seir in the land of Edom.

[22] The sons of Lotan were Hori and Hemam. Timna was Lotan's sister.
[23] These are the sons of Shobal: Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, and Onam.
[24] These are the sons of Zibeon: Aiah and Anah. (This is the Anah who found the hot springs in the wilderness as he was pasturing the donkeys of his father Zibeon.)
[25] These are the children of Anah: Dishon and Oholibamah daughter of Anah.
[26] These are the sons of Dishon: Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, and Cheran.
[27] These are the sons of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan, and Akan.
[28] These are the sons of Dishan: Uz and Aran.
[29] These are the chiefs of the Horites: Chiefs Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah,
[30] Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. They are the chiefs of the Horites, according to their divisions in the land of Seir.
[31] These are the kings who reigned in the land of Edom before any king reigned over the Israelites:
[32] Bela son of Beor reigned in Edom; the name of his city was Dinhabah.
[33] When Bela died, Jobab son of Zerah from Bozrah reigned in his place.
[34] When Jobab died, Husham from the land of the Temanites reigned in his place.
[35] When Husham died, Hadad son of Bedad, who defeated Midian in the country of Moab, reigned in his place. And the name of his city was Avith.
[36] When Hadad died, Samlah from Masrekah reigned in his place.
[37] When Samlah died, Shaul from Rehoboth on the Euphrates reigned in his place.
[38] When Shaul died, Baal-hanan son of Achbor reigned in his place.
[39] When Baal-hanan son of Achbor died, Hadad reigned in his place. His city was named Pau, and his wife's name was Mehetabel daughter of Matred, the daughter of Me-zahab.
[40] These are the names of Esau's chiefs, according to their families and regions, by their names: Chiefs Timna, Alvah, Jetheth,
[41] Oholibamah, Elah, Pinon,
[42] Kenaz, Teman, Mibzar,
[43] Magdiel, and Iram. These were the chiefs of Edom, according to their settlements in the land they possessed. Esau was the father of the Edomites.

37 Now Jacob lived in the land where his father had resided, the land of Canaan. [2] This is the account of Jacob. When Joseph was seventeen years old, he was tending the flock with his brothers, the sons of his father's wives Bilhah and Zilpah, and he brought their father a bad report about them. [3] Now Israel loved Joseph more than his other sons, because Joseph had been born to him in his old age; so he made him a robe of many colors. [4] When Joseph's brothers saw that their father loved him more than any of them, they hated him and could not speak a kind word to him. [5] Then Joseph had a dream, and when he told it to his brothers, they hated him even more. [6] He said to them, "Listen to this dream I had:" [7] "We were binding sheaves of grain in the field, and suddenly my sheaf rose and stood upright, while your sheaves gathered around and bowed down to mine." [8] "Do you intend to reign over us?" his brothers asked. "Will you actually rule us?" So they hated him even more because of his dream and his statements. [9] Then Joseph had another dream and told it to his brothers. "Look," he said, "I had another dream, and this time the sun and moon and eleven stars were bowing down to me." [10] He told his father and brothers, but his father rebuked him and said, "What is this dream that you have had? Will your mother and brothers and I actually come and bow down to the ground before you?" [11] And his brothers were jealous of him, but his father kept in mind what he had said.

[12] Some time later, Joseph's brothers had gone to pasture their father's flocks near Shechem. [13] Israel said to him, "Are not your brothers pasturing the flocks at Shechem? Get ready; I am sending you to them." "I am ready," Joseph replied. [14] Then Israel told him, "Go now and see how your brothers and the flocks are faring, and bring word back to me." So he sent him off from the Valley of Hebron. And when Joseph arrived in Shechem, [15] a man found him wandering in the field and asked, "What are you looking for?" [16] "I am looking for my brothers," Joseph replied. "Can you please tell me where they are pasturing their flocks?" [17] "They have moved on from here," the man answered. "I heard them say, 'Let us go to Dothan.'" So Joseph set out after his brothers and found them at Dothan. [18] Now Joseph's brothers saw him in the distance, and before he arrived, they plotted to kill him. [19] "Here comes that dreamer!" they said to one another. [20] "Come now, let us kill him and throw him into one of the pits. We can say that a vicious animal has devoured him. Then we shall see what becomes of his dreams!" [21] When Reuben heard this, he tried to rescue Joseph from their hands. "Let us not take his life," he said. [22] "Do not shed his blood. Throw him into this pit in the wilderness, but do not lay a hand on him." Reuben said this so that he could rescue Joseph from their hands and return him to his father. [23] So when Joseph came to his brothers, they stripped him of his robe—the robe of many colors he was wearing—

[24] and they took him and threw him into the pit. Now the pit was empty, with no water in it. [25] And as they sat down to eat a meal, they looked up and saw a caravan of Ishmaelites coming from Gilead. Their camels were carrying spices, balm, and myrrh on their way down to Egypt.

[26] Then Judah said to his brothers, "What profit will we gain if we kill our brother and cover up his blood?" [27] "Come, let us sell him to the Ishmaelites and not lay a hand on him; for he is our brother, our own flesh." And they agreed. [28] So when the Midianite traders passed by, his brothers pulled Joseph out of the pit and sold him for twenty shekels of silver to the Ishmaelites, who took him to Egypt. [29] When Reuben returned to the pit and saw that Joseph was not there, he tore his clothes, [30] returned to his brothers, and said, "The boy is gone! What am I going to do?" [31] Then they took Joseph's robe, slaughtered a young goat, and dipped the robe in its blood. [32] They sent the robe of many colors to their father and said, "We found this. Examine it to see whether it is your son's robe or not." [33] His father recognized it and said, "It is my son's robe! A vicious animal has devoured him. Joseph has surely been torn to pieces!" [34] Then Jacob tore his clothes, put sackcloth around his waist, and mourned for his son many days. [35] All his sons and daughters tried to comfort him, but he refused to be comforted. "No," he said. "I will go down to Sheol mourning for my son." So his father wept for him. [36] Meanwhile, the Midianites sold Joseph in Egypt to Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh and captain of the guard.

38 About that time, Judah left his brothers and settled near a man named Hirah, an Adullamite. [2] There Judah saw the daughter of a Canaanite man named Shua, and he took her as a wife and slept with her. [3] So she conceived and gave birth to a son, and Judah named him Er. [4] Again she conceived and gave birth to a son, and she named him Onan. [5] Then she gave birth to another son and named him Shelah; it was at Chezib that she gave birth to him. [6] Now Judah acquired a wife for Er, his firstborn, and her name was Tamar. [7] But Er, Judah's firstborn, was wicked in the sight of the LORD; so the LORD put him to death. [8] Then Judah said to Onan, "Sleep with your brother's wife. Perform your duty as her brother-in-law and raise up offspring for your brother." [9] But Onan knew that the offspring would not belong to him; so whenever he would sleep with his brother's wife, he would spill his seed on the ground so that he would not produce offspring for his brother.

[10] What he did was wicked in the sight of the LORD, so He put Onan to death as well. [11] Then Judah said to his daughter-in-law Tamar, "Live as a widow in your father's house until my son Shelah grows up." For he thought, "He may die too, like his brothers." So Tamar went to live in her father's house. [12] After a long time Judah's wife, the daughter of Shua, died. When Judah had finished mourning, he and his friend Hirah the Adullamite went up to his sheepshearers at Timnah. [13] When Tamar was told, "Your father-in-law is going up to Timnah to shear his sheep," [14] she removed her widow's garments, covered her face with a veil to disguise herself, and sat at the entrance to Enaim, which is on the way to Timnah. For she saw that although Shelah had grown up, she had not been given to him as a wife. [15] When Judah saw her, he thought she was a prostitute because she had covered her face. [16] Not realizing that she was his daughter-in-law, he went over to her and said, "Come now, let me sleep with you." "What will you give me for sleeping with you?" she inquired. [17] "I will send you a young goat from my flock," Judah answered. But she replied, "Only if you leave me something as a pledge until you send it." [18] "What pledge should I give you?" he asked. She answered, "Your seal and your cord, and the staff in your hand." So he gave them to her and slept with her, and she became pregnant by him. [19] Then Tamar got up and departed. And she removed her veil and put on her widow's garments again.

[20] Now when Judah sent his friend Hirah the Adullamite with the young goat to collect the items he had left with the woman, he could not find her. [21] He asked the men of that place, "Where is the shrine prostitute who was beside the road at Enaim?" "No shrine prostitute has been here," they answered. [22] So Hirah returned to Judah and said, "I could not find her, and furthermore, the men of that place said, 'No shrine prostitute has been here.'" [23] "Let her keep the items," Judah replied. "Otherwise we will become a laughingstock. After all, I did send her this young goat, but you could not find her." [24] About three months later, Judah was told, "Your daughter-in-law Tamar has prostituted herself, and now she is pregnant." "Bring her out!" Judah replied. "Let her be burned to death!" [25] As she was being brought out, Tamar sent a message to her father-in-law: "I am pregnant by the man to whom these items belong." And she added, "Please examine them. Whose seal and cord and staff are these?" [26] Judah recognized the items and said, "She is more righteous than I, since I did not give her to my son Shelah." And he did not have relations with her again. [27] When the time came for Tamar to give birth, there were twins in her womb. [28] And as she was giving birth, one of them put out his hand; so the midwife took a scarlet thread and tied it around his wrist. "This one came out first," she announced. [29] But when he pulled his hand back and his brother came out, she said, "You have broken out first!" So he was named Perez. [30] Then his brother came out with the scarlet thread around his wrist, and he was named Zerah.

39 Meanwhile, Joseph had been taken down to Egypt, where an Egyptian named Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh and captain of the guard, bought him from the Ishmaelites who had taken him there. [2] And the LORD was with Joseph, and he became a successful man, serving in the household of his Egyptian master. [3] When his master saw that the LORD was with him and made him prosper in all he did, [4] Joseph found favor in his sight and became his personal attendant. Potiphar put him in charge of his household and entrusted him with everything he owned. [5] From the time that he put Joseph in charge of his household and all he owned, the LORD blessed the Egyptian's household on account of him. The LORD's blessing was on everything he owned, both in his house and in his field. [6] So Potiphar left all that he owned in Joseph's care; he did not concern himself with anything except the food he ate. Now Joseph

was well-built and handsome, [7] and after some time his master's wife cast her eyes upon Joseph and said, "Sleep with me." [8] But he refused. "Look," he said to his master's wife, "with me here, my master does not concern himself with anything in his house, and he has entrusted everything he owns to my care." [9] "No one in this house is greater than I am. He has withheld nothing from me except you, because you are his wife. So how could I do such a great evil and sin against God?" [10] Although Potiphar's wife spoke to Joseph day after day, he refused to go to bed with her or even be near her. [11] One day, however, Joseph went into the house to attend to his work, and not a single household servant was inside. [12] She grabbed Joseph by his cloak and said, "Sleep with me!" But leaving his cloak in her hand, he escaped and ran outside. [13] When she saw that he had left his cloak in her hand and had run out of the house, [14] she called her household servants. "Look," she said, "this Hebrew has been brought to us to make sport of us. He came to me so he could sleep with me, but I screamed as loud as I could."

[15] "When he heard me scream for help, he left his cloak beside me and ran out of the house." [16] So Potiphar's wife kept Joseph's cloak beside her until his master came home.

[17] Then she told him the same story: "The Hebrew slave you brought us came to me to make sport of me," [18] "but when I screamed for help, he left his cloak beside me and ran out of the house." [19] When his master heard the story his wife told him, saying, "This is what your slave did to me," he burned with anger. [20] So Joseph's master took him and had him thrown into the prison where the king's prisoners were confined. While Joseph was there in the prison, [21] the LORD was with him and extended kindness to him, granting him favor in the eyes of the prison warden. [22] And the warden put all the prisoners under Joseph's care, so that he was responsible for all that was done in the prison. [23] The warden did not concern himself with anything under Joseph's care, because the LORD was with Joseph and gave him success in whatever he did.

40 Some time later, the king's cupbearer and baker offended their master, the king of Egypt. [2] Pharaoh was angry with his two officers, the chief cupbearer and the chief baker, [3] and imprisoned them in the house of the captain of the guard, the same prison where Joseph was confined. [4] The captain of the guard assigned them to Joseph, and he became their personal attendant. After they had been in custody for some time, [5] both of these men—the Egyptian king's cupbearer and baker, who were being held in the prison—had a dream on the same night, and each dream had its own meaning. [6] When Joseph came to them in the morning, he saw that they were distraught.

[7] So he asked the officials of Pharaoh who were in custody with him in his master's house, "Why are your faces so downcast today?" [8] "We both had dreams," they replied, "but there is no one to interpret them." Then Joseph said to them, "Don't interpretations belong to God? Tell me your dreams." [9] So the chief cupbearer told Joseph his dream: "In my dream there was a vine before me," [10] and on the vine were three branches. As it budded, its blossoms opened and its clusters ripened into grapes. [11] "Pharaoh's cup was in my hand, and I took the grapes, squeezed them into his cup, and placed the cup in his hand." [12] Joseph replied, "This is the interpretation: The three branches are three days." [13] Within three days Pharaoh will lift up your head and restore your position. You will put Pharaoh's cup in his hand, just as you did when you were his cupbearer. [14] But when it goes well for you, please remember me and show me kindness by mentioning me to Pharaoh, that he might bring me out of this prison.

[15] "For I was kidnapped from the land of the Hebrews, and even here I have done nothing for which they should have put me in this dungeon." [16] When the chief baker saw that the interpretation was favorable, he said to Joseph, "I too had a dream: There were three baskets of white bread on my head." [17] "In the top basket were all sorts of baked goods for Pharaoh, but the birds were eating them out of the basket on my head."

[18] Joseph replied, "This is the interpretation: The three baskets are three days." [19] "Within three days Pharaoh will lift off your head and hang you on a tree. Then the birds will eat the flesh of your body." [20] On the third day, which was Pharaoh's birthday, he held a feast for all his officials, and in their presence he lifted up the heads of the chief cupbearer and the chief baker. [21] Pharaoh restored the chief cupbearer to his position, so that he once again placed the cup in Pharaoh's hand. [22] But Pharaoh hanged the chief baker, just as Joseph had described to them in his interpretation. [23] The chief cupbearer, however, did not remember Joseph; he forgot all about him.

41 After two full years had passed, Pharaoh had a dream: He was standing beside the Nile, [2] when seven cows, sleek and well-fed, came up from the river and began to graze among the reeds. [3] After them, seven other cows, sickly and thin, came up from the Nile and stood beside the well-fed cows on the bank of the river. [4] And the cows that were sickly and thin devoured the seven sleek, well-fed cows. Then Pharaoh woke up, [5] but he fell back asleep and dreamed a second time: Seven heads of grain, plump and ripe, came up on one stalk. [6] After them, seven other heads of grain sprouted, thin and scorched by the east wind. [7] And the thin heads of grain swallowed up the seven plump, ripe ones. Then Pharaoh awoke and realized it was a dream. [8] In the morning his spirit was troubled, so he summoned all the magicians and wise men of Egypt. Pharaoh told them his dreams, but no one could interpret them for him. [9] Then the chief cupbearer said to Pharaoh, "Today I recall my failures." [10] Pharaoh was once angry with his servants, and he put me and the chief baker in the custody of the captain of the guard. [11] One night both the chief baker and I had dreams, and each dream had its own meaning. [12] Now a young Hebrew was there with us, a servant of the captain of the guard. We told him our dreams and he interpreted them for us individually. [13] "And it happened to us just as he had interpreted: I was restored to my position, and the other man was hanged." [14] So Pharaoh sent for Joseph, who was quickly brought out of the dungeon. After he had shaved and changed his clothes, he went in before Pharaoh. [15] Pharaoh said to Joseph, "I had a dream, and no one can interpret it. But I have heard it said of you that when you hear a dream you can interpret it." [16] "I myself cannot do it," Joseph replied, "but God will give Pharaoh a sound answer." [17] Then Pharaoh said to Joseph: "In my dream I was standing on the bank of the Nile," [18] when seven cows, well-fed and sleek, came up from the river and began to graze among the reeds.

[19] After them, seven other cows—sickly, ugly, and thin—came up. I have never seen such ugly cows in all the land of Egypt! [20] Then the thin, ugly cows devoured the seven well-fed cows that were there first. [21] When they had devoured them, however, no one could tell that they had done so; their appearance was as ugly as it had been before. Then I awoke. [22] In my dream I also saw seven heads of grain, plump and ripe, growing on a single stalk. [23] After them, seven other heads of grain sprouted—withered, thin, and scorched by the east wind. [24] "And the thin heads of grain swallowed the seven plump ones. I told this dream to the magicians, but no one could explain it to me."

[25] At this, Joseph said to Pharaoh, "The dreams of Pharaoh are one and the same. God has revealed to Pharaoh what He is about to do." [26] The seven good cows are seven years, and the seven ripe heads of grain are seven years. The dreams have the same meaning. [27] Moreover, the seven thin, ugly cows that came up after them are seven years, and so are the seven worthless heads of grain scorched by the east wind—they are seven years of famine. [28] It is just as I said to Pharaoh: God has shown Pharaoh what He is about to do. [29] Behold, seven years of great abundance are coming throughout the land of Egypt, [30] but seven years of famine will follow them. Then all the abundance in the land of Egypt will be forgotten, and the famine will devastate the land. [31] The abundance in the land will not be remembered, since the famine that follows it will be so severe. [32] Moreover, because the dream was given to Pharaoh in two versions, the matter has been decreed by God, and He will carry it out shortly. [33] Now, therefore, Pharaoh should look for a discerning and wise man and set him over the land of Egypt. [34] Let Pharaoh take action and appoint commissioners over the land to take a fifth of the harvest of Egypt during the seven years of abundance. [35] Under the authority of Pharaoh, let them collect all the excess food from these good years, that they may come and lay up the grain to be preserved as food in the cities. [36] "This food will be a reserve for the land during the seven years of famine to come upon the land of Egypt. Then the country will not perish in the famine." [37] This proposal pleased Pharaoh and all his officials.

[38] So Pharaoh asked them, "Can we find anyone like this man, in whom the Spirit of God abides?" [39] Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Since God has made all this known to you, there is no one as discerning and wise as you." [40] "You shall be in charge of my house, and all my people are to obey your commands. Only with regard to the throne will I be greater than you." [41] Pharaoh also told Joseph, "I hereby place you over all the land of Egypt." [42] Then Pharaoh removed the signet ring from his finger, put it on Joseph's finger, clothed him in garments of fine linen, and placed a gold chain around his neck. [43] He had Joseph ride in his second chariot, with men calling out before him, "Bow the knee!" So he placed him over all the land of Egypt. [44] And Pharaoh declared to Joseph, "I am Pharaoh, but without your permission, no one in all the land of Egypt shall lift his hand or foot." [45] Pharaoh gave Joseph the name Zaphenath-paneah, and he gave him Asenath daughter of Potiphera, priest of On, to be his wife. And Joseph took charge of all the land of Egypt. [46] Now Joseph was thirty years old when he entered the service of Pharaoh king of Egypt. And Joseph left Pharaoh's presence and traveled throughout the land of Egypt. [47] During the seven years of abundance, the land brought forth bountifully. [48] During those seven years, Joseph collected all the excess food in the land of Egypt and stored it in the cities. In every city he laid up the food from the fields around it. [49] So Joseph stored up grain in such abundance, like the sand of the sea, that he stopped keeping track of it; for it was beyond measure. [50] Before the years of famine arrived, two sons were born to Joseph by Asenath daughter of Potiphera, priest of On. [51] Joseph named the firstborn Manasseh, saying, "God has made me forget all my hardship and all my father's household." [52] And the second son he named Ephraim, saying, "God has made me fruitful in the land of my affliction." [53] When the seven years of abundance in the land of Egypt came to an end, [54] the seven years of famine began, just as Joseph had said. And although there was famine in every country, there was food throughout the land of Egypt. [55] When extreme hunger came to all the land of Egypt and the people cried out to Pharaoh for food, he told all the Egyptians, "Go to Joseph and do whatever he tells you." [56] When the famine had spread over all the land, Joseph opened up all the storehouses and sold grain to the Egyptians; for the famine was severe in the land of Egypt. [57] And every nation came to Joseph in Egypt to buy grain, because the famine was severe over all the earth.

42 When Jacob learned that there was grain in Egypt, he said to his sons, "Why are you staring at one another?" [2] "Look," he added, "I have heard that there is grain in Egypt. Go down there and buy some for us, so that we may live and not die." [3] So ten of Joseph's brothers went down to buy grain from Egypt.

[4] But Jacob did not send Joseph's brother Benjamin with his brothers, for he said, "I am afraid that harm might befall him." [5] So the sons of Israel were among those who came to buy grain, since the famine had also spread to the land of Canaan. [6] Now Joseph was the ruler of the land; he was the one who sold grain to all its people. So when his brothers arrived, they bowed down before him with their faces to the ground. [7] And when Joseph saw his brothers, he recognized them, but he treated them as strangers and spoke harshly to them. "Where have you come from?" he asked. "From the land of Canaan," they replied. "We are here to buy food." [8] Although Joseph recognized his brothers, they did not recognize him. [9] Joseph remembered his dreams about them and said, "You are spies! You have come to see if our land is vulnerable." [10] "Not so, my lord," they replied. "Your servants have come to buy food." [11] "We are all sons of one man. Your servants are honest men, not spies."

[12] "No," he told them. "You have come to see if our land is vulnerable." [13] But they answered, "Your servants are twelve brothers, the sons of one man in the land of Canaan. The youngest is now with our father, and one is no more." [14] Then Joseph declared, "Just as I said, you are spies!" [15] And this is how you will be tested: As surely as Pharaoh lives, you shall not leave this place unless your youngest brother comes here. [16] "Send one of your number to get your brother; the rest of you will be confined so that the truth of your words may be tested. If they are untrue, then as surely as Pharaoh lives, you are spies!" [17] So Joseph imprisoned them for three days, [18] and on the third day he said to them, "I fear God. So do this and you will live: [19] If you are honest, leave one of your brothers in custody while the rest of you go and take back grain to relieve the hunger of your households. [20] Then bring your youngest brother to me so that your words can be verified, that you may not die." And to this they consented. [21] Then they said to one another, "Surely we are being punished because of our brother. We saw his anguish when he pleaded with us, but we would not listen. That is why this distress has come upon us."

[22] And Reuben responded, "Didn't I tell you not to sin against the boy? But you would not listen. Now we must account for his blood!" [23] They did not realize that Joseph understood them, since there was an interpreter between them. [24] And he turned away from them and wept. When he turned back and spoke to them, he took Simeon from them and had him bound before their eyes.

[25] Then Joseph gave orders to fill their bags with grain, to return each man's silver to his sack, and to give them provisions for their journey. This order was carried out, [26] and they loaded the grain on their donkeys and departed. [27] At the place where they lodged for the night, one of them opened his sack to get feed for his donkey, and he saw his silver in the mouth of the sack. [28] "My silver has been returned!" he said to his brothers. "It is here in my sack." Their hearts sank, and trembling, they turned to one another and said, "What is this that God has done to us?" [29] When they reached their father Jacob in the land of Canaan, they described to him all that had happened to them: [30] "The man who is lord of the land spoke harshly to us and accused us of spying on the country." [31] But we told him, 'We are honest men, not spies.' [32] We are twelve brothers, sons of one father. One is no more, and the youngest is now with our father in the land of Canaan.' [33] Then the man who is lord of the land said to us, 'This is how I will know whether you are honest: Leave one brother with me, take food to relieve the hunger of your households, and go.' [34] "But bring your youngest brother back to me so I will know that you are not spies but honest men. Then I will give your brother back to you, and you can trade in the land.'" [35] As they began emptying their sacks, there in each man's sack was his bag of silver! And when they and their father saw the bags of silver, they were dismayed. [36] Their father Jacob said to them, "You have deprived me of my sons. Joseph is gone and Simeon is no more. Now you want to take Benjamin. Everything is going against me!" [37] Then Reuben said to his father, "You may kill my two sons if I fail to bring him back to you. Put him in my care, and I will return him." [38] But Jacob replied, "My son will not go down there with you, for his brother is dead, and he alone is left. If any harm comes to him on your journey, you will bring my gray hair down to Sheol in sorrow."

43 Now the famine was still severe in the land. [2] So when Jacob's sons had eaten all the grain they had brought from Egypt, their father said to them, "Go back and buy us a little more food." [3] But Judah replied, "The man solemnly warned us, 'You will not see my face again unless your brother is with you.'" [4] If you will send our brother with us, we will go down and buy food for you. [5] "But if you will not send him, we will not go; for the man told us, 'You will not see my face again unless your brother is with you.'" [6] "Why did you bring this trouble upon me?" Israel asked. "Why did you tell the man you had another brother?" [7] They replied, "The man questioned us in detail about ourselves and our family: 'Is your father still alive? Do you have another brother?' And we answered him accordingly. How could we possibly know that he would say, 'Bring your brother here'?" [8] And Judah said to his father Israel, "Send the boy with me, and we will go at once, so that we may live and not die—neither we, nor you, nor our children." [9] I will guarantee his safety. You may hold me personally responsible. If I do not bring him back and set him before you, then may I bear the guilt before you all my life. [10] "If we had not delayed, we could have come and gone twice by now."

[11] Then their father Israel said to them, "If it must be so, then do this: Put some of the best products of the land in your packs and carry them down as a gift for the man—a little balm and a little honey, spices and myrrh, pistachios and almonds." [12] Take double the silver with you so that you may return the silver that was put back into the mouths of your sacks. Perhaps it was a mistake. [13] Take your brother as well, and return to the man at once. [14] "May God Almighty grant you mercy before the man, that he may release your other brother along with Benjamin. As for me, if I am bereaved, I am bereaved."

[15] So the men took these gifts, along with double the amount of silver, and Benjamin as well. Then they hurried down to Egypt and stood before Joseph. [16] When Joseph saw Benjamin with his brothers, he said to the steward of his house, "Take these men to my house. Slaughter an animal and prepare it, for they shall dine with me at noon." [17] The man did as Joseph had commanded and took the brothers to Joseph's house. [18] But the brothers were frightened that they had been taken to Joseph's house. "We have been brought here because of the silver that was returned in our bags the first time," they said. "They intend to overpower us and take us as slaves, along with our donkeys." [19] So they approached Joseph's steward and spoke to him at the entrance to the house. [20] "Please, sir," they said, "we really did come down here the first time to buy food." [21] But when we came to the place we lodged for the night, we opened our sacks and, behold, each of us found his silver in the mouth of his sack! It was the full amount of our silver, and we have brought it back with us.

[22] "We have brought additional silver with us to buy food. We do not know who put our silver in our sacks." [23] "It is fine," said the steward. "Do not be afraid. Your God, the God of your father, gave you the treasure that was in your sacks. I received your silver." Then he brought Simeon out to them. [24] And the steward took the men into Joseph's house, gave them water to wash their feet, and provided food for their donkeys. [25] Since the brothers had been told that they were going to eat a meal there, they prepared their gift for Joseph's arrival at noon. [26] When Joseph came home, they presented him with the gifts they had brought, and they bowed to the ground before him. [27] He asked if they were well, and then he asked, "How is your elderly father you told me about? Is he still alive?" [28] "Your servant our father is well," they answered. "He is still alive." And they bowed down to honor him. [29] When Joseph looked up and saw his brother Benjamin, his own mother's son, he asked, "Is this your youngest brother, the one you told me about?" Then he declared, "May God be gracious to you, my son." [30] Joseph hurried out because he was moved to tears for his brother, and he went to a private room to weep. [31] Then he washed his face and came back out. Regaining his composure, he said, "Serve the meal." [32] They separately served Joseph, his brothers, and the Egyptians. They ate separately because the Egyptians would not eat with the Hebrews, since that was detestable to them. [33] They were seated before Joseph in order by age, from the firstborn to the youngest, and the men looked at one another in astonishment. [34] When the portions were served to them from Joseph's table, Benjamin's portion was five times larger than any of the others. So they feasted and drank freely with Joseph.

44 Then Joseph instructed his steward: "Fill the men's sacks with as much food as they can carry, and put each one's silver in the mouth of his sack." [2] "Put my cup, the silver one, in the mouth of the youngest one's sack, along with the silver for his grain." So the steward did as Joseph had instructed. [3] At daybreak, the men were sent on their way with their donkeys. [4] They had not gone far from the city when Joseph told his steward, "Pursue the men at once, and when you overtake them, ask, 'Why have you repaid good with evil?'" [5] "Is this not the cup my master drinks from and uses for divination? What you have done is wicked!'" [6] When the steward overtook them, he relayed these words to them. [7] "Why does my lord say these things?" they asked. "Your servants could not possibly do such a thing." [8] We even brought back to you from the land of Canaan the silver we found in the mouths of our sacks. Why would we steal silver or gold from your master's house? [9] "If any of your servants is found to have it, he must die, and the rest will become slaves of my lord." [10] "As you say," replied the steward. "But only the one who is found with the cup will be my slave, and the rest of you shall be free of blame."

[11] So each one quickly lowered his sack to the ground and opened it. [12] The steward searched, beginning with the oldest and ending with the youngest—and the cup was found in Benjamin's sack. [13] Then they all tore their clothes, loaded their donkeys, and returned to the city. [14] When Judah and his brothers arrived at Joseph's house, he was still there, and they fell to the ground before him. [15] "What is this deed you have done?" Joseph declared. "Do you not know that a man like me can surely divine the truth?"

[16] "What can we say to my lord?" Judah replied. "How can we plead? How can we justify ourselves? God has exposed the iniquity of your servants. We are now my lord's slaves—both we and the one who was found with the cup." [17] But Joseph replied, "Far be it from me to do this. The man who was found with the cup will be my slave. The rest of you may return to your father in peace." [18] Then Judah approached Joseph and said, "Sir, please let your servant speak personally to my lord. Do not be angry with your servant, for you are equal to Pharaoh himself." [19] My lord asked his servants, 'Do you have a father or a brother?' [20] And we answered, 'We have an elderly father and a younger brother, the child of his old age. The boy's brother is dead. He is the only one of his mother's sons left, and his father loves him.' [21] Then you told your servants, 'Bring him down to me so that I can see him for myself.'

[22] So we said to my lord, 'The boy cannot leave his father. If he were to leave, his father would die.' [23] But you said to your servants, 'Unless your younger brother

comes down with you, you will not see my face again.' [24] Now when we returned to your servant my father, we relayed your words to him. [25] Then our father said, 'Go back and buy us some food.' [26] But we answered, 'We cannot go down there unless our younger brother goes with us. So if our younger brother is not with us, we cannot see the man.' [27] And your servant my father said to us, 'You know that my wife bore me two sons.' [28] When one of them was gone, I said: "Surely he has been torn to pieces." And I have not seen him since. [29] Now if you also take this one from me and harm comes to him, you will bring my gray hair down to Sheol in sorrow.' [30] So if the boy is not with us when I return to your servant, and if my father, whose life is wrapped up in the boy's life, [31] sees that the boy is not with us, he will die. Then your servants will have brought the gray hair of your servant our father down to Sheol in sorrow. [32] Indeed, your servant guaranteed the boy's safety to my father, saying, 'If I do not return him to you, I will bear the guilt before you, my father, all my life.' [33] Now please let your servant stay here as my lord's slave in place of the boy. Let him return with his brothers. [34] "For how can I go back to my father without the boy? I could not bear to see the misery that would overwhelm him."

45 Then Joseph could no longer control himself before all his attendants, and he cried out, "Send everyone away from me!" So none of them were with Joseph when he made himself known to his brothers. [2] But he wept so loudly that the Egyptians heard him, and Pharaoh's household soon heard of it. [3] Joseph said to his brothers, "I am Joseph! Is my father still alive?" But they were unable to answer him, because they were terrified in his presence. [4] Then Joseph said to his brothers, "Please come near me." And they did so. "I am Joseph, your brother," he said, "the one you sold into Egypt!" [5] And now, do not be distressed or angry with yourselves that you sold me into this place, because it was to save lives that God sent me before you. [6] For the famine has covered the land these two years, and there will be five more years without plowing or harvesting. [7] God sent me before you to preserve you as a remnant on the earth and to save your lives by a great deliverance. [8] Therefore it was not you who sent me here, but God, who has made me a father to Pharaoh—lord of all his household and ruler over all the land of Egypt.

[9] Now return quickly to my father and tell him, 'This is what your son Joseph says: God has made me lord of all Egypt. Come down to me without delay.' [10] You shall settle in the land of Goshen and be near me—you and your children and grandchildren, your flocks and herds, and everything you own. [11] And there I will provide for you, because there will be five more years of famine. Otherwise, you and your household and everything you own will come to destitution.' [12] Behold! You and my brother Benjamin can see that I, Joseph, am the one speaking with you. [13] "Tell my father about all my splendor in Egypt and everything you have seen. And bring my father down here quickly." [14] Then Joseph threw his arms around his brother Benjamin and wept, and Benjamin wept as they embraced. [15] Joseph kissed each of his brothers as he wept over them. And afterward his brothers talked with him. [16] When the news reached Pharaoh's house that Joseph's brothers had come, Pharaoh and his servants were pleased.

[17] Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Tell your brothers, 'Do as follows: Load your animals and return to the land of Canaan.'"

[18] Then bring your father and your families and return to me. I will give you the best of the land of Egypt, and you shall eat from the fat of the land.' [19] You are also directed to tell them: 'Take wagons from the land of Egypt for your young children and your wives, and bring your father and come back.' [20] "But pay no regard to your belongings, for the best of all the land of Egypt is yours.'" [21] So the sons of Israel did as they were told. Joseph gave them wagons as Pharaoh had instructed, and he also gave them provisions for their journey. [22] He gave new garments to each of them, but to Benjamin he gave three hundred shekels of silver and five sets of clothes. [23] And he sent to his father the following: ten donkeys loaded with the best of Egypt, and ten female donkeys loaded with grain and bread and provisions for his father's journey. [24] Then Joseph sent his brothers on their way, and as they were leaving, he said to them, "Do not quarrel on the way!" [25] So the brothers went up out of Egypt and came to their father Jacob in the land of Canaan. [26] "Joseph is still alive," they said, "and he is ruler over all the land of Egypt!" But Jacob was stunned, for he did not believe them. [27] However, when they relayed all that Joseph had told them, and when he saw the wagons that Joseph had sent to carry him back, the spirit of their father Jacob was revived. [28] "Enough!" declared Israel. "My son Joseph is still alive! I will go to see him before I die."

46 So Israel set out with all that he had, and when he came to Beersheba, he offered sacrifices to the God of his father Isaac. [2] And that night God spoke to Israel in a vision: "Jacob, Jacob!" He said. "Here I am," replied Jacob. [3] "I am God," He said, "the God of your father. Do not be afraid to go down to Egypt, for I will make you into a great nation there." [4] "I will go down with you to Egypt, and I will surely bring you back. And Joseph's own hands will close your eyes." [5] Then Jacob departed from Beersheba, and the sons of Israel took their father Jacob in the wagons Pharaoh had sent to carry him, along with their children and wives. [6] They also took the livestock and possessions they had acquired in the land of Canaan, and Jacob and all his offspring went to Egypt. [7] Jacob took with him to Egypt his sons and grandsons, and his daughters and granddaughters—all his offspring.

[8] Now these are the names of the sons of Israel (Jacob and his descendants) who went to Egypt: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn.

[9] The sons of Reuben: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi.

[10] The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jachin, Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanite woman.

[11] The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.

[12] The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, Shelah, Perez, and Zerah; but Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan. The sons of Perez: Hezron and Hamul.

[13] The sons of Issachar: Tola, Puvah, Job, and Shimron.

[14] The sons of Zebulun: Sered, Elon, and Jahleel.

[15] These are the sons of Leah born to Jacob in Paddan-aram, in addition to his daughter Dinah. The total number of sons and daughters was thirty-three.

[16] The sons of Gad: Ziphion, Haggi, Shuni, Ezbon, Eri, Arodi, and Areli.

[17] The children of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, Beriah, and their sister Serah. The sons of Beriah: Heber and Malchiel.

[18] These are the sons of Jacob born to Zilpah—whom Laban gave to his daughter Leah—sixteen in all.

[19] The sons of Jacob's wife Rachel: Joseph and Benjamin.

[20] Manasseh and Ephraim were born to Joseph in the land of Egypt by Asenath daughter of Potiphera, priest of On.

[21] The sons of Benjamin: Bela, Becher, Ashbel, Gera, Naaman, Ehi, Rosh, Muppim, Huppim, and Ard.

[22] These are the sons of Rachel born to Jacob—fourteen in all.

[23] The son of Dan: Hushim.

[24] The sons of Naphtali: Jahzeel, Guni, Jezer, and Shillem.

[25] These are the sons of Jacob born to Bilhah, whom Laban gave to his daughter Rachel—seven in all.

[26] All those belonging to Jacob who came to Egypt—his direct descendants, besides the wives of Jacob's sons—numbered sixty-six persons.

[27] And with the two sons who had been born to Joseph in Egypt, the members of Jacob's family who went to Egypt were seventy in all. [28] Now Jacob had sent Judah ahead of him to Joseph to get directions to Goshen. When Jacob's family arrived in the land of Goshen, [29] Joseph prepared his chariot and went there to meet his father Israel. Joseph presented himself to him, embraced him, and wept profusely. [30] Then Israel said to Joseph, "Finally I can die, now that I have seen your face and know that you are still alive!" [31] Joseph said to his brothers and to his father's household, "I will go up and inform Pharaoh: 'My brothers and my father's household from the land of Canaan have come to me.'" [32] The men are shepherds; they raise livestock, and they have brought their flocks and herds and all that they own.' [33] When Pharaoh summons you and asks, 'What is your occupation?' [34] "you are to say, 'Your servants have raised livestock ever since our youth—both we and our fathers.' Then you will be allowed to settle in the land of Goshen, since all shepherds are detestable to the Egyptians."

47 So Joseph went and told Pharaoh: "My father and my brothers, with their flocks and herds and all they own, have come from the land of Canaan and are now in Goshen." [2] And he chose five of his brothers and presented them before Pharaoh. [3] "What is your occupation?" Pharaoh asked Joseph's brothers. "Your servants are shepherds," they replied, "both we and our fathers." [4] Then they said to Pharaoh, "We have come to live in the land for a time, because there is no pasture for the flocks of your servants, since the famine in the land of Canaan has been severe. So now, please allow your servants to settle in the land of Goshen." [5] Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Now that your father and brothers have come to you," [6] "the land of Egypt is before you; settle your father and brothers in the best part of the land. They may dwell in the land of Goshen. And if you know of any talented men among them, put them in charge of my own livestock." [7] Then Joseph brought in his father Jacob and presented him before Pharaoh, and Jacob blessed Pharaoh. [8] "How many years have you lived?" Pharaoh asked. [9] "My travels have lasted 130 years," Jacob replied. "My years have been few and hard, and they have not matched the years of the travels of my fathers."

[10] Then Jacob blessed Pharaoh and departed from his presence. [11] So Joseph settled his father and brothers in the land of Egypt and gave them property in the best part of the land, the district of Rameses, as Pharaoh had commanded. [12] Joseph also provided his father and brothers and all his father's household with food for their families. [13] There was no food, however, in all that region, because the famine was so severe; the lands of Egypt and Canaan had been exhausted by the famine. [14] Joseph collected all the money to be found in the land of Egypt and the land of Canaan in exchange for the grain they were buying, and he brought it into Pharaoh's palace. [15] When the money from the lands of Egypt and Canaan was gone, all the Egyptians came to Joseph and said, "Give us food. Why should we die before your eyes? For our funds have run out!" [16] "Then bring me your livestock," said Joseph. "Since the money is gone, I will sell you food in exchange for your livestock." [17] So they brought their livestock to Joseph, and he gave them food in exchange for their horses, their flocks and herds, and their donkeys. Throughout that year he provided them with food in exchange for all their livestock. [18] When that year was over, they came to him the second year and said, "We cannot hide from our lord that our money is gone and all our livestock belongs to you. There is nothing left for our lord except our bodies and our land." [19] "Why should we perish before your eyes—we and our land as well? Purchase us and our land in exchange for food. Then we, along with our land, will be slaves to Pharaoh. Give us seed that we may live and not die, and that the land may not become desolate."

20 So Joseph acquired for Pharaoh all the land in Egypt; the Egyptians, one
and all, sold their fields because the famine was so severe upon them. The land
became Pharaoh's, 21 and Joseph reduced the people to servitude from one end
of Egypt to the other. 22 However, he did not acquire the priests' portion of the
land, for it had been given to them by Pharaoh. They ate the rations that Pharaoh
supplied; so they did not sell their land. 23 Then Joseph said to the people, "Now
that I have acquired you and your land for Pharaoh this day, here is seed for you
to sow in the land." 24 "At harvest time, you are to give a fifth of it to Pharaoh,
and four-fifths will be yours as seed for the field and food for yourselves and
your households and children." 25 "You have saved our lives," they said. "We have
found favor in our lord's eyes, and we will be Pharaoh's servants." 26 So Joseph
established a law that a fifth of the produce belongs to Pharaoh, and it is in
effect in the land of Egypt to this day. Only the priests' land does not belong
to Pharaoh. 27 Now the Israelites settled in the land of Egypt, in the region of
Goshen. They acquired property there and became fruitful and increased greatly
in number. 28 And Jacob lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years, and the length
of his life was 147 years. 29 When the time drew near for Israel to die, he called his
son Joseph and said to him, "If I have found favor in your eyes, put your hand
under my thigh and promise to show me kindness and faithfulness. Do not bury
me in Egypt," 30 "but when I lie down with my fathers, carry me out of Egypt
and bury me with them." Joseph answered, "I will do as you have requested."
31 "Swear to me," Jacob said. So Joseph swore to him, and Israel bowed in worship
at the head of his bed.

48 Some time later Joseph was told, "Your father is ill." So he set out with his
two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim. 2 When Jacob was told, "Your son Joseph has
come to you," Israel rallied his strength and sat up in bed. 3 Jacob said to Joseph,
"God Almighty appeared to me at Luz in the land of Canaan, and there He
blessed me" 4 and told me, 'Behold, I will make you fruitful and multiply you; I
will make you a multitude of peoples, and will give this land to your descendants
after you as an everlasting possession.' 5 And now your two sons born to you
in Egypt before I came to you here shall be reckoned as mine; Ephraim and
Manasseh shall be mine, just as Reuben and Simeon are mine. 6 Any children
born to you after them shall be yours, and they shall be called by the names of
their brothers in the territory they inherit.

7 "Now as for me, when I was returning from Paddan, to my sorrow Rachel
died along the way in the land of Canaan, some distance from Ephrath. So I
buried her there beside the road to Ephrath" (that is, Bethlehem). 8 When Israel
saw the sons of Joseph, he asked, "Who are these?" 9 Joseph said to his father,
"They are the sons God has given me in this place." So Jacob said, "Please bring
them to me, that I may bless them." 10 Now Israel's eyesight was poor because of
old age; he could hardly see. Joseph brought his sons to him, and his father kissed
them and embraced them.

11 "I never expected to see your face again," Israel said to Joseph, "but now
God has let me see your children as well." 12 Then Joseph removed his sons from
his father's knees and bowed facedown. 13 And Joseph took both of them—with
Ephraim in his right hand toward Israel's left hand, and Manasseh in his left hand
toward Israel's right hand—and brought them close to him.

14 But Israel stretched out his right hand and put it on the head of Ephraim, the
younger; and crossing his hands, he put his left on Manasseh's head, although
Manasseh was the firstborn. 15 Then he blessed Joseph and said: "May the God
before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac walked, the God who has been my
shepherd all my life to this day," 16 "the angel who has redeemed me from all
harm— may He bless these boys. And may they be called by my name and the
names of my fathers Abraham and Isaac, and may they grow into a multitude
upon the earth." 17 When Joseph saw that his father had placed his right hand
on Ephraim's head, he was displeased and took his father's hand to move it from
Ephraim's head to Manasseh's. 18 "Not so, my father!" Joseph said. "This one is
the firstborn; put your right hand on his head." 19 But his father refused. "I know,
my son, I know!" he said. "He too shall become a people, and he too shall be great;
nevertheless, his younger brother shall be greater than he, and his offspring shall
become a multitude of nations." 20 So that day Jacob blessed them and said: "By
you shall Israel pronounce this blessing: 'May God make you like Ephraim and
Manasseh.'" So he put Ephraim before Manasseh. 21 Then Israel said to Joseph,
"Look, I am about to die, but God will be with you and bring you back to the
land of your fathers." 22 "And to you, as one who is above your brothers, I give
the ridge of land that I took from the Amorites with my sword and bow."

49 Then Jacob called for his sons and said, "Gather around so that I can tell
you what will happen to you in the days to come:" 2 Come together and listen,
O sons of Jacob; listen to your father Israel. 3 Reuben, you are my firstborn, my
might, and the beginning of my strength, excelling in honor, excelling in power.
4 Uncontrolled as the waters, you will no longer excel, because you went up to
your father's bed, onto my couch, and defiled it. 5 Simeon and Levi are brothers;
their swords are weapons of violence. 6 May I never enter their council; may I
never join their assembly. For they kill men in their anger, and hamstring oxen on
a whim. 7 Cursed be their anger, for it is strong, and their wrath, for it is cruel! I
will disperse them in Jacob and scatter them in Israel. 8 Judah, your brothers shall
praise you. Your hand shall be on the necks of your enemies; your father's sons
shall bow down to you. 9 Judah is a young lion— my son, you return from the
prey. Like a lion he crouches and lies down; like a lioness, who dares to rouse him?

10 The scepter will not depart from Judah, nor the staff from between his feet,
until Shiloh comes and the allegiance of the nations is his.

11 He ties his donkey to the vine, his colt to the choicest branch. He washes
his garments in wine, his robes in the blood of grapes. 12 His eyes are darker than
wine, and his teeth are whiter than milk. 13 Zebulun shall dwell by the seashore
and become a harbor for ships; his border shall extend to Sidon. 14 Issachar is
a strong donkey, lying down between the sheepfolds. 15 He saw that his resting
place was good and that his land was pleasant, so he bent his shoulder to the
burden and submitted to labor as a servant.

16 Dan shall provide justice for his people as one of the tribes of Israel. 17 He will be
a snake by the road, a viper in the path that bites the horse's heels so that its rider
tumbles backward. 18 I await Your salvation, O LORD. 19 Gad will be attacked by
raiders, but he will attack their heels. 20 Asher's food will be rich; he shall provide
royal delicacies. 21 Naphtali is a doe set free that bears beautiful fawns.

22 Joseph is a fruitful vine— a fruitful vine by a spring, whose branches
scale the wall. 23 The archers attacked him with bitterness; they aimed at him
in hostility. 24 Yet he steadied his bow, and his strong arms were tempered by
the hands of the Mighty One of Jacob, in the name of the Shepherd, the Rock
of Israel, 25 by the God of your father who helps you, and by the Almighty who
blesses you, with blessings of the heavens above, with blessings of the depths
below, with blessings of the breasts and womb. 26 The blessings of your father
have surpassed the blessings of the ancient mountains and the bounty of the
everlasting hills. May they rest on the head of Joseph, on the brow of the prince of
his brothers. 27 "Benjamin is a ravenous wolf; in the morning he devours the prey,
in the evening he divides the plunder." 28 These are the tribes of Israel, twelve in
all, and this was what their father said to them. He blessed them, and he blessed
each one with a suitable blessing. 29 Then Jacob instructed them, "I am about
to be gathered to my people. Bury me with my fathers in the cave in the field of
Ephron the Hittite." 30 The cave is in the field of Machpelah near Mamre, in the
land of Canaan. This is the field Abraham purchased from Ephron the Hittite as
a burial site. 31 There Abraham and his wife Sarah are buried, there Isaac and his
wife Rebekah are buried, and there I buried Leah. 32 "The field and the cave that
is in it were purchased from the Hittites." 33 When Jacob had finished instructing
his sons, he pulled his feet into the bed and breathed his last, and he was gathered
to his people.

50 Then Joseph fell upon his father's face, wept over him, and kissed him.
2 And Joseph directed the physicians in his service to embalm his father Israel. So
they embalmed him, 3 taking the forty days required to complete the embalming.
And the Egyptians mourned for him seventy days. 4 When the days of mourning
had passed, Joseph said to Pharaoh's court, "If I have found favor in your eyes,
please tell Pharaoh that" 5 "my father made me swear an oath when he said, 'I am
about to die. You must bury me in the tomb that I dug for myself in the land of
Canaan.' Now let me go and bury my father, and then return." 6 Pharaoh replied,
"Go up and bury your father, as he made you swear to do." 7 Then Joseph went
to bury his father, and all the servants of Pharaoh accompanied him—the elders
of Pharaoh's household and all the elders of the land of Egypt—

8 along with all of Joseph's household, and his brothers, and his father's
household. Only their children and flocks and herds were left in Goshen.
9 Chariots and horsemen alike went up with him, and it was an exceedingly
large procession. 10 When they reached the threshing floor of Atad, which is
across the Jordan, they lamented and wailed loudly, and Joseph mourned for his
father seven days. 11 When the Canaanites of the land saw the mourning at the
threshing floor of Atad, they said, "This is a solemn ceremony of mourning by
the Egyptians." Thus the place across the Jordan is called Abel-mizraim.

12 So Jacob's sons did as he had charged them. 13 They carried him to the land
of Canaan and buried him in the cave at Machpelah in the field near Mamre,
which Abraham had purchased from Ephron the Hittite as a burial site. 14 After
Joseph had buried his father, he returned to Egypt with his brothers and all who
had gone with him to bury his father. 15 When Joseph's brothers saw that their
father was dead, they said, "What if Joseph bears a grudge? Then he will surely
repay us for all the evil that we did to him." 16 So they sent word to Joseph,
saying, "Before he died, your father commanded," 17 "'This is what you are to say
to Joseph: I beg you, please forgive the transgression and sin of your brothers,
for they did you wrong.' So now, Joseph, please forgive the transgression of
the servants of the God of your father." When their message came to him,
Joseph wept. 18 His brothers also came to him, bowed down before him, and said,
"We are your slaves!" 19 But Joseph replied, "Do not be afraid. Am I in the place
of God?" 20 As for you, what you intended against me for evil, God intended for
good, in order to accomplish a day like this—to preserve the lives of many people.
21 "Therefore do not be afraid. I will provide for you and your little ones." So
Joseph reassured his brothers and spoke kindly to them. 22 Now Joseph and his
father's household remained in Egypt, and Joseph lived to the age of 110. 23 He
saw Ephraim's sons to the third generation, and indeed the sons of Machir son of
Manasseh were brought up on Joseph's knees. 24 Then Joseph said to his brothers,
"I am about to die, but God will surely visit you and bring you up from this land
to the land He promised on oath to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob." 25 And Joseph
made the sons of Israel take an oath and said, "God will surely attend to you, and
then you must carry my bones up from this place." 26 So Joseph died at the age
of 110. And they embalmed his body and placed it in a coffin in Egypt.

ATRIA CONTROL · BLK-002 · CHAPTER NIL · 01/1